In year 6, a lot has happened. First, the business stakeholders realize the value of sharing and combining data. Still, they also realize this is possible only with additional rules set by the governance body and automated checks. The automatic execution of the federated governance rules adds a final word to the topic of this chapter—*computational*—which makes it *federated computational governance*. The following is our definition; again, we consciously try to be as inclusive as possible.

DEFINITION *Federated computational data governance* is a data governance model in which policies are translated into algorithms and enforced automatically by the IT infrastructure wherever feasible.

Let's now try to convince you why you should consider data governance a good investment rather than the collateral cost of data mesh development.

6.2 Benefits of data governance

The problem with describing the benefits of any high-level solution is that they tend to reflect an ideal world. Let's look at some of the data governance benefit categories and discuss the underlying assumptions required for the benefit to occur.

This should help you form your own opinion about the amount of effort you'll want to invest in this topic. Also, it will help facilitate discussions with the stakeholders you decide to involve.

6.2.1 Business value perspective

Let's think about the significance of data governance on decision-making processes in your company. There is a common belief that a decision-maker who has access to a relatively large volume of data should feel well equipped to make decisions. However, such a volume of data comes with its challenges.

First, it's easy to get to the point of information overload. A high volume of data may lead someone to the conclusion that they have "more than enough" data. But, sometimes the volume may be misleading, as all the accessible